

Digital Addiction Assessment Toolkit (DAAT) for Parents



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FOR PARENTS

Welcome to the Digital Addiction Assessment Tool (DAAT) for Parents. The DAAT helps objectively assess your child's relationship with technology. It considers the unique context of Sri Lanka and does not offer medical advice. Your observations are crucial in identifying signs of digital addiction. Reflect on your child's behaviors and experiences with screen time using a series of statements. Use the results for self-reflection and open conversations with your child. Remember, each child is unique, and the goal is to find a healthy balance for their development. Seek professional guidance if needed. Together, let's foster a healthy relationship with technology for our children's well-being.

ANSWER SCALE/SCORE

① Never ② Rarely ③ Sometimes ④ Often ⑤ Always

① Never I have never experienced or observed the behavior described in the DAAT for parents.

② Rarely The behavior described in the DAAT occurs very infrequently or on extremely rare occasions.

③ Sometimes The behavior described in the DAAT occurs occasionally or in specific situations, but not with regularity.

④ Often The behavior described in the DAAT occurs frequently or on a regular basis.

⑤ Always The behavior described in the DAAT consistently occurs or happens nearly every time or all the time.

FOR PARENTS

BEHAVIORS EXPERIENCED BY CHILDREN AND YOUTH

① Never

② Rarely

③ Sometimes

④ Often

⑤ Always

1.	My child mindlessly passes time on a regular basis by staring at his or her smartphone, tablet, or computer, even when there might be better or more productive activities to do. They also tend to lose track of time when using these devices.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
2.	My child shows signs of anger, frustration, or sadness when his or her smartphone, tablet, or other device is taken away.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
3.	My child tries to deceive me about his or her screen use, including the duration of time and the purpose of usage.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
4.	My child exhibits a lack of interest in socializing, such as looking at screens during dinner or other activities.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
5.	I clearly realize that excessive use of devices has affected my child's mental well-being and behavior.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
6.	My child does not pay attention to discussions with parents, easily forgets things, and cannot concentrate on work assigned at home.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
7.	My child does not sleep well due to his or her interest in using devices.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
8.	My child displays a lack of interest in activities that don't involve screens, such as reading, walking, playing, or working in the garden.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	

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9.	My child's screen use has interfered with his or her ability to complete school work and other duties at home.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
10.	My child prefers spending more time with virtual friends than their own siblings.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
11.	My child's thoughts and words mainly revolve around video games, internet videos, or other screen-based media, even when he or she isn't actively using their devices.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
12.	My child's screen use negatively affects family relationships, especially in terms of how he or she interacts with parents and siblings.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
13.	My child makes unusual and risky decisions for practical issues, and I believe it is influenced by excessive device use.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
14.	I have observed a change in my child's vision, either losing sight to see things that are closer or faraway.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
15.	My child shows a lower energy level for engaging in studies and other tasks at home.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
16.	My child appears to be only happy when he or she is using a device.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
17.	My child sleeps with his or her phone or tablet, or loses sleep due to technology use.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	

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18.	My child spends more time with "virtual friends" compared to interacting with real people nearby.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
19.	I have noticed an increase in the amount of time my child spends on digital devices and the Internet.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
20.	My child regularly sleeps with his or her smartphone on or next to their bed.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
21.	I am aware that my child uses devices alone after everyone else at home has gone to sleep.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
22.	I find my child viewing and answering texts, tweets, and emails at all hours of the day and night, even when it means interrupting other activities such as schoolwork, meals, sports, or family time.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
23.	I limit, block, or filter Internet and digital screen-time access for my child.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
24.	My child's use of technology decreases his or her academic productivity and real-time socialization, family participation, and physical activity.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
25.	My child shows discomfort when he or she accidentally leaves his or her phone or other internet/digital device in the car or at home, or when he or she has no service, or his or her device is broken	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	

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26.	My child prefers being alone at home, even when we want to go out for dinner, visit family, or spend some family time together.	① ② ③ ④ ⑤	
27.	My child prefers spending more time at relative's places where there is less control over the use of devices.		
28.	My child claims to study a lot of time, but I know that they regularly and repeatedly visit other online sites for entertainment.		
29.	I find it difficult to limit or remove my child's use of digital technology, and when I do, they exhibit strong emotional or physical reactions.		
30.	My child frequently experiences symptoms such as feeling tired, sluggish, irritable, tense, and restless.		

The Digital Addiction Assessment Tool (DAAT) provides a score with a maximum value of 110.

RESULTS

Scale	Definition	Recommendations
Minimal Digital Addiction (0-37.5)	This range indicates a minimal level of digital addiction in your child. It suggests that their usage is within healthy limits and does not significantly interfere with daily life, relationships, education, or overall functioning.	a. Encourage balanced digital usage: Promote a healthy balance between digital activities and other offline activities such as hobbies, sports, or spending time with family and friends. b. Set clear boundaries: Establish clear rules and time limits for digital usage, ensuring that it doesn't overshadow other important aspects of life. c. Encourage outdoor activities: Foster an appreciation for nature and outdoor pursuits to reduce reliance on digital devices.

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Minimal Digital Addiction (0-37.5)	This range indicates a minimal level of digital addiction in your child. It suggests that their usage is within healthy limits and does not significantly interfere with daily life, relationships, education, or overall functioning.	d. Promote social interactions: Encourage face-to-face interactions and social engagements with peers to enhance social skills and reduce excessive reliance on digital communication.
Mild Digital Addiction (37.5-75)	This range suggests a mild level of digital addiction. It implies that their digital usage is starting to have a noticeable impact on various aspects of their life, such as daily routines, relationships, education, and overall functioning. It is a warning sign to monitor their usage and make necessary adjustments.	a. Foster open communication: Create a safe and non-judgmental environment where your child feels comfortable discussing their digital habits and any concerns they may have. b. Explore alternative activities: Encourage your child to explore new hobbies or interests that can help divert their attention from excessive digital usage.

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Mild Digital Addiction (37.5-75)	This range suggests a mild level of digital addiction. It implies that their digital usage is starting to have a noticeable impact on various aspects of their life, such as daily routines, relationships, education, and overall functioning. It is a warning sign to monitor their usage and make necessary adjustments.	a. Foster open communication: Create a safe and non-judgmental environment where your child feels comfortable discussing their digital habits and any concerns they may have. b. Explore alternative activities: Encourage your child to explore new hobbies or interests that can help divert their attention from excessive digital usage.
High Addiction (75-112.5)	This range indicates a high level of digital addiction. It signifies that the individual's dependency on digital devices and online activities has significantly impacted various aspects of their life. They may experience a pervasive preoccupation with screens, struggling to regulate and control their usage.	a. Seek professional help: Consult with a licensed therapist or counselor who specializes in digital addiction. They can provide guidance, support, and strategies to address the addiction and its effects.

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High Addiction (75-112.5)	The addiction is likely to have severe consequences on their daily routines, relationships, academic or work performance, and overall well-being.	b. Monitor and restrict access: Utilize parental control tools or apps that can help monitor and limit your child's digital usage. These tools can assist in setting appropriate time limits and blocking access to certain apps or websites. c. Engage in joint activities: Participate in activities together that encourage bonding and provide opportunities for quality time away from digital devices. d. Create a technology-free routine: Establish specific times during the day or week where digital devices are put away, allowing for dedicated time for other activities, such as reading or engaging in hobbies.

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Scale	Definition	Recommendations
Severe Digital Addiction (112.5-150):	This range represents a severe level of digital addiction. It suggests that their addiction is at an alarming level and has a profound impact on various aspects of their life. Their daily routines, relationships, education, and overall functioning are severely disrupted. Mental well-being is greatly affected, leading to high levels of stress, anxiety, and potential risks to physical health.	- Intensive therapy or rehabilitation: Consider enrolling your child in an intensive therapy program or digital addiction rehabilitation center that provides comprehensive support and treatment for severe cases. - Involve support networks: Seek support from support groups or communities for digital addiction. Connecting with others who have experienced similar challenges can provide valuable insights and emotional support. - Establish a structured schedule: Create a daily routine that includes designated periods for digital usage and offline activities, providing a sense of structure and balance.

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Scale	Definition	Recommendations
Severe Digital Addiction (112.5-150):	This range represents a severe level of digital addiction. It suggests that their addiction is at an alarming level and has a profound impact on various aspects of their life. Their daily routines, relationships, education, and overall functioning are severely disrupted. Mental well-being is greatly affected, leading to high levels of stress, anxiety, and potential risks to physical health.	d. Promote self-care practices: Encourage your child to engage in self-care activities such as mindfulness, relaxation exercises, or pursuing hobbies that promote emotional well-being and reduce reliance on digital devices.

NOTE FOR PARENTS

The Digital Addiction Assessment Tool (DAAT) has been specifically designed for parents and has undergone extensive consultations in various parts of Sri Lanka to ensure its relevance in the local context. However, it is important to note that the DAAT should not be used as a basis for prescribing medication. Instead, it serves as an educational and awareness-building tool. If you have concerns about your child's digital addiction, it is crucial to seek professional advice. Remember that these recommendations are general and should be tailored to the specific needs and circumstances of the child and their family. Seeking guidance from a physician or qualified healthcare provider can provide valuable insights and appropriate support for addressing severe digital addiction or persistent concerns.

OPTIONAL SCALES :

Here are four different scales with corresponding marks and their definitions for measuring digital addiction:

Scale	Definition
Minimal Digital Addiction (0-37.5)	• 0-9: No significant signs of digital addiction. • 10-19: Minimal signs of digital addiction, with occasional excessive device use. • 20-29: Some signs of digital addiction, but still manageable and not severely impacting daily life. • 30-37.5: Slight dependency on digital devices, but still able to maintain control and engage in other activities.
Mild Digital Addiction (37.5-75)	• 37.5-49: Mild signs of digital addiction, with noticeable impact on daily routine and productivity. • 50-59: Moderate signs of digital addiction, with difficulty in managing screen time and occasional disruption of relationships and responsibilities. • 60-69: Significant signs of digital addiction, leading to decreased focus on non-digital activities and strained relationships. • 70-75: Noticeable dependency on digital devices, with difficulty in regulating usage and significant negative impact on well-being.

High Digital Addiction (75-112.5)	• 75-84: higher signs of digital addiction, with substantial disruption in daily life, relationships, and academic or work performance. • 85-94: Increased dependency on digital devices, with frequent preoccupation and difficulty disengaging from screen-related activities. • 95-104: Significant signs of digital addiction, leading to impaired functionality in various aspects of life and strained personal relationships. • 105-112.5: Highly dependent on digital devices, experiencing severe difficulty in controlling usage and experiencing significant negative consequences.
Severe Digital Addiction (112.5-150)	• 112.5-121: Severe signs of digital addiction, with an overwhelming preoccupation with devices and an inability to engage in other activities. • 122-131: Extreme dependency on digital devices, with severe disruption to daily life, deteriorating relationships, and impaired mental well-being. • 132-141: Critical signs of digital addiction, resulting in a complete disregard for other responsibilities, with drawal from social interactions, and severe negative consequences.

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Severe Digital Addiction (112.5-150)	• 142-150: Extremely severe digital addiction, with an all-consuming focus on screens, causing severe deterioration of physical and mental health, isolation, and significant harm to relationships and overall functioning.
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Note

Please note that these scales provide a framework for assessing the severity of digital addiction based on the assigned marks. It's important to recognize that the impact and severity of digital addiction can vary from person to person. These scales serve as a tool for reflection and are not definitive or universally applicable. The intention is to provide a general framework for understanding the potential severity of digital addiction in an individual's life.